Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

THIRD REGULAR SESSION

RESOLUTION NO. 236

RESOLUTION EXPRESSING THE SINCEREST APPRECIATION AND PROFOUND GRATITUDE OF THE BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY (BTA) PARLIAMENT TO THE UNITED NATIONS GENERAL ASSEMBLY FOR PROCLAIMING MARCH 15 AS THE INTERNATIONAL DAY TO COMBAT ISLAMOPHOBIA

WHEREAS, Section 3, Article III of the 1987 Philippine Constitution provides that the right to free exercise and enjoyment of religious profession and worship, without discrimination or preference, shall forever be allowed. No religious test shall be required for the exercise of civil or political rights;

WHEREAS, Section 10, Article IV of Republic Act No. 11054, otherwise known as the Bangsamoro Organic Law, provides that there shall be no discrimination on the basis of identity, religion, and ethnicity;

WHEREAS, Section 5, Article IX of the same law provides that the Bangsamoro Government shall guarantee religious freedom and the free exercise thereof pursuant to the Constitution, national laws, and principles of international law. The Bangsamoro Government shall protect all persons from harassment or any undue pressure, coercion, and violence on account of religion. Any establishment and institution shall be free to implement policies and undertake activities pursuant to their respective religious beliefs and values;

WHEREAS, Section 6, Article IX of the same law states that the Bangsamoro Government shall fully respect human rights;

WHEREAS, according to the definition by the Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC), "*Islamophobia*" is a combination of hate, fear, and prejudice against Islam, against Muslims, as well as against anything associated with the religion, such as Mosques, Islamic Centers, Holy Qur'an, Hijab, etc. It also constitutes hatred, stigmatization, racism, and discrimination in daily life, on media, at the workplace, in the political sphere, etc. It rests in the mind and it reflects in attitudes and could be manifested through violent actions, such as burning mosques, vandalizing properties, abusing women wearing scarf, or insulting Prophet or sacred symbols of Islam;

WHEREAS, Islamophobia is a worldwide concern. For instance, in the United States of America, according to a report by the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI), the number of assaults, attacks on mosques, and other hate crimes against Muslims in 2015 was higher than at any other time except the immediate aftermath of September 11. In 2015, there were 257 anti-Muslim incidents, up from 154 in 2014 -- a 67 percent increase. In 2001, 481 incidents were reported. There has also been a dramatic growth of organized anti-Muslim hate groups, with the number of such groups jumping from 34 in 2015 to 101 in 2016 -- a 197 percent increase;

WHEREAS, the 193-member United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) has unanimously adopted a resolution proposed by the OIC and Pakistan to designate March 15 the International Day to Combat Islamophobia;

WHEREAS, the resolution was co-sponsored by 57 members of the OIC, including Afghanistan, Bangladesh, China, Egypt, Indonesia, Iran, Iraq, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Kuwait, Kyrgyzstan, Lebanon, Libya, Malaysia, Maldives, Mali, Pakistan, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Turkey, Turkmenistan, Uganda, United Arab Emirates, Uzbekistan, and Yemen;

racism that includes, among others, discriminatory travel bans, hate speech, and the targeting of girls and women for their dress. The text called for expanded international efforts to create a global dialogue that will encourage tolerance and peace centered on respect for human rights and the diversity of religions and beliefs;

WHEREAS, the resolution strongly condemns all acts of violence against persons on the basis of their religion or belief and such act directed at their places of worship, as well as all attacks on and in religious places, sites and shrines that are in violation of international law;

WHEREAS, the resolution asks all countries, UN bodies, international and regional organizations, civil society, private sectors, and faith-based organizations "to organize and support various high-visibility events aimed at effectively increasing awareness of all levels about curbing Islamophobia," and to observe the new International Day to Combat Islamophobia;

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro people have their share of experiences confronting forms of discrimination. Thus, in addition to its expression of support, the Bangsamoro should encourage dialogue and mobilize activities in observance of the International Day to Combat Islamophobia;

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro Government advocates the promotion of a culture of tolerance, respect, and peace amongst all people and nations;

WHEREAS, the Moro National Liberation Front, a party in the Bangsamoro Transition Authority, is conferred with observer status in the OIC:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority, to express the sincerest appreciation and profound gratitude of the BTA Parliament to the United Nations General Assembly for proclaiming March 15 as the International Day to Combat Islamophobia.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, to forward the foregoing Resolution to the United Nations Office in the Philippines, for information.

ADOPTED, Sha'baan 18, 1443/March 22, 2022.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. ALI PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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